



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Armis Dei Classical Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.armisdeiacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Armis Dei Classical Christian Academy (WI 54501) presents a robust Classical Christian profile across most of the Six Essential Elements rubric. Public-facing materials emphasize a biblically grounded, virtuous formation trajectory, partnership with families, and a classical curriculum focused on grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, and the reading of great literature. The school frames its mission around leading students with biblical truth and a historically informed Christian worldview, with explicit commitments to parental partnership and faculty formation in a Christ-centered, classical pedagogy. The strongest signals lie in religious/metaphysical foundations, school purpose/goals, curriculum, faculty, and parent/community alignment. Pedagogy shows substantial classical roots (grammar/logic/rhetoric, classical model, reading of great books, cooperative/home-education hybrid), but has less explicit, publicly stated detail about Socratic seminars, scholé, or formal Great Conversation structures compared to the strongest classical exemplars. Overall, the school meets the criteria for CLASSICAL with room to more explicitly codify some pedagogical practices that are hallmark traits of the fullest Classical model.

Executive-level takeaway by category: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: CLASSICAL - Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Faculty: CLASSICAL - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

These judgments are grounded in direct public statements from the school (mission, admissions, curriculum notes, faculty and parent-partner messaging) and cross-referenced with the Positive/Negative keyword indicators drawn from the classical education rubric. For example, the school's public materials emphasize biblical truth, a Christian worldview, and a partnership with families (positive alignments with "truth, theology, liturgy/worship, catechesis," and "partnership with families") and explicitly name grammar/logic/rhetoric and Latin as core components of the curriculum. See evidence snippets and citations throughout the category-by-category notes. Key sources include the admissions and mission language, the statements about biblical truth and Christian worldview, the explicit mention of Bible/logic/rhetoric/Latin in the curriculum, and testimonials about the public-facing classical model.

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Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize biblical truth and a biblical worldview as core framing for education. For example, the school describes itself as a "classical education that is unashamedly biblical" and highlights forming students "in the love of all of God's truth so that they might live with courage in the world for His glory." - Admissions materials reference prayer and a faith-based framing of the admissions process (e.g., "We'll be in prayer along with you..."). - Faculty mission statements emphasize mature Christian professionals, involvement in local churches, and a Christ-centered ethos (e.g., "mature Christians... active part of their local church"). - Testimonials and mission language describe a biblical worldview shaping curriculum and community (e.g., "biblical worldview," "God's truth," and "the discipline and instruction of the Lord" as part of parent involvement).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: biblical, God, biblical worldview, truth, discipline and instruction of the Lord, prayer, local church, mature Christians, glory. - Negative keywords present: none observed in public materials. - Quantitative note: 8–9 distinct positive items identified; 0 negative items identified in the public-facing texts reviewed.

Why this rating - The school's materials repeatedly foreground transcendent truths (truth, God's truth, biblical worldview) and communal/ritual aspects (prayer, church involvement) that align strongly with Transcendental moral realism and a theological grounding. The lack of explicit liturgical practice terms (e.g., liturgy, Mass, chapel) in the visible materials does not undermine the overall religious-metaphysical orientation given the explicit biblical framing and theological commitments. Therefore, CLASSICAL is warranted. [filecite\turn0file2\turn0file0\turn0file6\turn0file7](#)

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school states a mission to mature students in the love of God's truth for courageous living, with an emphasis on leading rather than simply responding to culture. This signals formation-focused aims rather than mere workforce preparation. - A public statement highlights a rigorous classical education that is biblically grounded and designed to equip students to engage culture from a Christian worldview. - A testimonial notes education that teaches students "HOW to Think and not WHAT to think," signaling a formation-oriented pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, biblical, worldview, courage, lead, formation (implied), God's truth, intellectual formation via classical model. - Negative keywords present: none explicitly (no stated emphasis on purely vocational/workforce-skills language in the public materials). - Quantitative note: 4–6 positive items identified; 0 explicit negative items identified in the public materials.

Why this rating - The messaging centers on character formation, virtue, and truth as ends of education, not primarily on job readiness or workforce preparation. This aligns with CLASSICAL rather than a purely utilitarian or career-focused framing. [filecite\turn0file1\turn0file2\turn0file6](#)

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as classical (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with explicit mention of Bible, logic, rhetoric, and Latin as core courses. This mirrors the Trivium-based structure and classical language study. - The school notes engagement with great literature and a classical model that includes the study of "the great books of western civilization" and a historically informed Christian worldview. Public materials reference reading of great literature and classical canon concepts. - The site references a relationship to history and classical disciplines consistent with classical curriculum aims (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Bible, great books/reading of great literature, classical, history (contextual framing), formation via classical education. - Negative keywords present: none explicitly (no strong signaling of replacing history with social studies or non-classical approaches). - Quantitative note: 5–7 positive items identified; 0 explicit negative items identified.

Why this rating - Clear alignment with the classical curriculum schema: Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Latin, Great Books/Great Conversation in their stated orientation, and a historical/Western-civilization emphasis. The explicit mention of "great books" and "classical model" strengthens CLASSICAL status. [filecite\turn0file4\turn0file2](#)

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials reference a classical model with Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric training for students, and a home-school cooperative model that blends in-class and at-home learning. This shows a structured classical pedagogy with a cooperative/multi-modal approach. - There are explicit mentions of "two days in school, three days at home" as part of a cooperative model, indicating a blended pedagogy

rather than a purely on-site, lecture-dominated approach. This suggests a significant classical orientation, but the public materials do not provide explicit, in-depth descriptions of Socratic seminars, scholé days, or formal Great Conversation seminars that characterize the fullest high-school classical pedagogy. - Public references to “our mission for faculty” and “living curriculum” support a classical approach to pedagogy grounded in mentorship and character formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric, Latin; classical model; great books (via mention of reading great literature); “leading and not merely responding to culture” (formation-through-teaching ethos). - Negative keywords present: not explicitly present; however, explicit, detailed descriptions of Socratic seminars, scholé days, or a fully articulated upper-school seminar program are not explicitly documented in the public materials. This reduces the certainty of a full high-school Socratic/seminar pedagogy in the public materials. - Quantitative note: 5–6 positive items identified; 0 explicit negative items documented in the public materials; explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy is not clearly evidenced.

Why this rating - The school clearly adopts classical pedagogical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, memorization/dialogue practices implied by a classical model) but lacks explicit public documentation of the full spectrum of high-school Socratic seminars, scholé days, and formal Great Conversation structures. Therefore, categorization as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL reflects strong classical underpinnings with room for more explicit pedagogy details. ☐filecite¹turn0file4¹turn0file6¹

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials present faculty as virtuous teachers who model Christian virtue, with language about “mature Christians,” “living curriculum,” and a team-oriented, collegial culture. This aligns with the classical ideal of teacher as exemplar and mentor. - The school describes a mission to hire faculty who are “growing examples” of virtue, who are “committed to building their own households in Christ,” and who participate in the local church, with emphasis on supportive collaboration and professional development. - Testimonials emphasize teachers who “love their students,” “encourage them,” and “bring life to their classrooms,” consistent with the “living curriculum” concept.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtuous teachers; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; mentorship; moral exemplars; lifelong learner orientation; Christian formation. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials. - Quantitative note: 6–7 positive keywords identified; 0 explicit negative items.

Why this rating - The public materials strongly align with the classical faculty ideal: teachers as models of virtue, living curriculum, and collaborative, supportive professional culture. This justifies CLASSICAL. ☐filecite¹turn0file7¹turn0file6¹

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly positions parents as partners and co-teachers, aligning with classical-community norms. There is emphasis on parental formation and engagement (e.g., parents as co-teachers, involvement in school life, and at-home/home-days roles). ☐filecite¹turn0file4¹turn0file6¹ - The materials note that Armis Dei aims to partner with parents in the education of children, and to be an asset to parents with visible opportunities for involvement and ongoing communication (e.g., home days, prayer, and active life in the school). - The school highlights an open-campus approach and ongoing gatherings and book studies as vehicles for parent education about classical education, reinforcing parent-forming community ties. ☐filecite¹turn0file4¹turn0file2¹

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, parental involvement, open campus, parent education (book studies, gatherings), living in community with churches. - Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials. - Quantitative note: 5–6 positive keywords identified; 0 explicit negative items.

Why this rating - The school's language and programs consistently treat parents as integral partners in classical education, fulfilling the "Partnership with Families" and "Household formation" signals in the Six Elements lexicon. Therefore, CLASSICAL is warranted. □filecite□turn0file1□turn0file6□

What Would Move the Needle

- If the school wants to move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL in Pedagogy, it could publicly codify explicit Socratic/seminal seminar structures for upper grades (e.g., explicit Harkness-style discussions, seminar formats, and Great Conversation-style curricula) and provide a clear Scholastic (Scholé) days in the schedule with evidence of contemplative, memory-based practice.
- Expand explicit references to the Great Conversation and Great Books across more grade levels, with sample syllabi or yearly cycles that connect literature to history, philosophy, and theology.
- Provide publicly accessible exemplars or case studies of how Great Books are integrated with Great Books discussions, including assessment rubrics that emphasize contemplation, moral reasoning, and intellectual virtue.
- Normalize more explicit liturgical or communal practices in publicly accessible pages (e.g., chapel programs, liturgical calendar, or communal prayer glimpses) to further align with Liturgical/Communal Practices expectations.

Note: The aggregate classification remains CLASSICAL, with Element 4 representing the primary area where explicit, public articulation could be strengthened to reach the highest Classical rubric across Pedagogy.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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